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ASSIGNMENT SUBMISSION

Course/Unit: Software Engineering
Assignment: Exercise A – User Manual Procedure
Topic: How to Create a GitHub Repository and Make Your First Commit
Student Name: Babil Jaffar Abdalla
Registration Number: PLP-ILO-2601-337
Lecturer: Wuor Simon
Submission Date: 10.10.2026

EXERCISE A: USER MANUAL PROCEDURE

Title: How to Create a GitHub Repository and Make Your First Commit

1. Introduction

This user manual explains how to create a GitHub repository from scratch and make the first commit. GitHub is an online platform used to store, manage, and share source code. A repository is a location where project files and their revision history are stored. A commit is a saved snapshot of changes made to files in a Git repository.

This procedure is intended for first-semester computing students who have basic computer literacy but no previous experience using GitHub and Git.

2. Prerequisites

Before starting this procedure, ensure that you have the following:

- A computer running Windows, macOS, or Linux.
- A stable internet connection.
- A GitHub account. If you do not have one, register at https://github.com.
- Git installed on your computer. Download it from https://git-scm.com/downloads.
- A text editor, such as Visual Studio Code or Notepad.
- Basic knowledge of opening a web browser and using a command-line terminal.

3. Step-by-Step Procedure

Step 1: Open GitHub

Action: Open a web browser and navigate to https://github.com.

Expected result: The GitHub homepage appears in the browser.

Step 2: Sign in to GitHub

Action: Enter your GitHub account credentials to sign in.

Expected result: The GitHub dashboard appears.

Step 3: Open the repository creation page

Action: Click the plus (+) icon in the upper-right corner and select **New repository**.

Expected result: The repository creation form appears.

Step 4: Enter the repository name

Action: Type `my-first-project` into the repository name field.

Expected result: The repository name appears in the form.

Step 5: Add a repository description

Action: Enter `My first GitHub project` in the description field.

Expected result: The description appears in the form.

Step 6: Choose the repository visibility

Action: Select **Public** as the repository visibility.

Expected result: The repository is configured to be publicly accessible.

Step 7: Initialize the repository

Action: Select the option to add a README file.

Expected result: The repository is configured to include a README file when created.

Step 8: Create the repository

Action: Click **Create repository**.

Expected result: GitHub displays the new repository page containing the README file.

Step 9: Open a terminal

Action: Open the terminal application on your computer.

Expected result: A command-line interface appears, ready to accept commands.

Step 10: Verify the Git installation

Action: Enter `git --version` in the terminal.

Expected result: The terminal displays the installed Git version.

Step 11: Configure your Git username

Action: Enter `git config --global user.name "Your Name"` in the terminal, replacing `Your Name` with your preferred name.

Expected result: Git stores your name for use in commit records.

Step 12: Configure your Git email

Action: Enter `git config --global user.email "you@example.com"` in the terminal, replacing the example address with your email address.

Expected result: Git stores your email address for use in commit records.

Step 13: Copy the repository URL

Action: Copy the HTTPS URL from the repository page using the **Code** button.

Expected result: The repository URL is copied to the clipboard.

Step 14: Clone the repository

Action: Run `git clone https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/my-first-project.git` in the terminal, replacing `YOUR-USERNAME` with your GitHub username.

Expected result: Git downloads the repository into a new local folder named `my-first-project`.

Step 15: Open the local repository folder

Action: Run `cd my-first-project` in the terminal.

Expected result: The terminal's working directory changes to the local repository folder.

Step 16: Create a project file

Action: Create a file named `hello.txt` containing the text `My first GitHub project.` using your text editor.

Expected result: The file `hello.txt` exists inside the local repository folder.

Step 17: Check the repository status

Action: Run `git status` in the terminal.

Expected result: Git identifies `hello.txt` as an untracked file.

Step 18: Stage the new file

Action: Run `git add hello.txt` in the terminal.

Expected result: The file is staged and ready to be included in a commit.

Step 19: Create the first commit

Action: Run `git commit -m "Add hello.txt"` in the terminal.

Expected result: Git creates a commit containing the new file and displays a confirmation message.

Step 20: Upload the commit to GitHub

Action: Run `git push origin main` in the terminal.

Expected result: The commit is uploaded to GitHub, and the remote repository contains `hello.txt`.

Note: This procedure assumes that the repository's default branch is named `main` and that GitHub authentication has been configured if required.

4. Screenshot Descriptions

Screenshot 1: GitHub Repository Creation Page

The screenshot should show the GitHub repository creation form with the repository name `my-first-project`, the description, the selected public visibility, and the option to add a README file. This screenshot demonstrates the configuration used before creating the repository.

Screenshot 2: Successful First Commit in the Terminal

The screenshot should show the terminal after the `git commit -m "Add hello.txt"` command has completed successfully. The output should indicate that a commit was created and that `hello.txt` was added.

Screenshot 3: Files Uploaded to GitHub

The screenshot should show the GitHub repository page with `README.md` and `hello.txt` listed among the repository files. This confirms that the first commit has been uploaded successfully.

5. Troubleshooting

Common problem: Git is not recognized as a command.

Cause: Git may not be installed, or its installation directory may not be included in the system's PATH environment variable.

Solution:

1. Download and install Git from https://git-scm.com/downloads.
2. Ensure that the installation configures Git for use from the command line.
3. Close and reopen the terminal.
4. Run `git --version` again to verify the installation.

If the error persists, check the installation settings and the system's PATH configuration.

6. Conclusion

By following this procedure, a beginner can create a GitHub repository, clone it to a local computer, create a project file, stage and commit the file, and upload the commit to GitHub. These skills provide a foundation for version control, collaboration, and software development projects.

Before you submit

- Replace the example email address and GitHub username with your own details where appropriate.
- Make sure Git is installed and you can sign in to GitHub before following the procedure.
- If your lecturer expects actual screenshots, capture them while performing the steps and insert them under Section 4.
- Keep the numbered steps separate because the assignment specifically requires exactly one action and an expected result in each step.

Important technical note: If GitHub creates a repository with a README, cloning it first and then adding `hello.txt` locally avoids the common problem of pushing unrelated initial histories. If your default branch is not `main`, check the branch name before running the push command.